Sales Rules of Engagement — Handout

Great Plains Communications

Sales-Navigator · Great Plains Communications

Public reference summary — always confirm details in the current ROE PDF and official Strategic list.

> ***Authoritative source***
> *Sales Rules of Engagement (ROE) — current revision on **Sales SharePoint** (link in **Reference** below). The **Strategic Accounts** list is maintained separately. **Informal spreadsheets are not authoritative** — use the official Sales SharePoint materials referenced in the ROE.*

At a glance

Topic	Rule (general path)
Prospect idle	**61+** days with no qualifying logged activity → others may work the account
Customer idle	**121+** days → others may work
Assigned inbound	First contact **and** Salesforce log within **5 business days**
Self-sourced leads	**Not** subject to the same 5-day clock as sales/marketing-assigned inbound

The reality check

The Rules of Engagement exist for **one reason**: to protect everyone's pipeline and keep **clear boundaries** across the team. **Salesforce is the undisputed system of record** — not Outlook, not chat, not side agreements.

The core mandates

Mandate	In practice
Search before you create	One entity, one account. Duplicates drive ownership fights, bad reporting, and **commission risk**.
Log it or lose it	Tasks, calls, meetings, or emails must live **on the Salesforce record**. Your **Sent** folder does not count in a dispute.
Transfer through leadership	Never reassign an account **unilaterally**. Align with the current owner, then **written** approval through your manager and sales leadership.

Strategic accounts and **E-Rate / USAC-funded** entities follow **different** rules than the general 61/121 path. Know which path applies **before** you engage.

System of record & data discipline

- **Search** by name and address before creating accounts or contacts.
- **Leadership** resolves conflicts from Salesforce — prioritize **data quality**, **timely logging**, and **meaningful activity** on the record.
- **No parallel accounts** to bypass an incumbent owner. If you need access, use the **transfer path**.

Idle windows *(general / non-strategic only)*

Qualifying activity = logged on the account in Salesforce (not email alone).

Record type	Threshold	Effect
Prospect	**61+** days no qualifying activity	Others may work the account
Customer	**121+** days	Others may work the account

Even when a window is **open by the numbers**, **reach the listed owner first** — then use formal transfer steps if needed. **No cowboy grabs.**

Assigned inbound — the 5-day clock

> ***Five business days*** *from assignment: make* ***first contact*** *and log it in* ***Salesforce****. Miss it, and the lead may be* ***re-routed****.*

> *This clock applies to **sales- or marketing-assigned inbound** — **not** the same rule as **self-sourced** prospecting.*

Strategic accounts & E-Rate / USAC

Area	Rule
Strategic Accounts (official list)	**Assignment** and list mechanics — **not** the generic 61/121 idle path
Who owns the official list	**Sales Managers** and **VP of Sales**; published via **official Sales SharePoint** (per ROE)
E-Rate / USAC-funded entities	**Strategic-style** treatment **even if** not on the named list (see ROE for documented exceptions, e.g. **ENA Indiana** → **Out-State Team**)
When unsure	Confirm with **leadership** — do **not** assume casual 61/121 applies

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Transfers & edge cases

Approved path (summary)

1. Talk to the **current owner** — get alignment.
2. Involve **your manager** and **sales leadership**.
3. Secure **written** approval **before** ownership changes.
4. **Never** reassign in Salesforce first to “force” a deal.

Roughly **~20%** of edge cases will not fit the ROE cleanly — **escalate to sales management** case by case; do not improvise policy. Use **Salesforce history** as evidence, not Slack polls or rumors.

Landmines *(deal-killers)*

If you hear yourself thinking…	The reality
"I emailed them twice—that counts."	**Sent Folder Delusion** — if it is not logged as a task, call, meeting, or email **on the record**, it **did not happen** for ROE purposes.
"130 days idle — I'll just start working it."	**Cowboy Grab** — window may be open, but **contact the listed owner first**; use leadership transfer if needed.
"I'll reassign it to myself in Salesforce."	**Rogue Reassignment** — **major violation**. Align + **written** leadership path only.
"School district = 61/121."	**E-Rate Trap** — USAC/E-Rate entities get **Strategic-style** treatment unless leadership confirms otherwise.
"Inbound lead — I'll get to it next week."	**5-Day Clock** — **five business days**, period, for assigned inbound **contact + log**.
"New account record is faster than talking to the owner."	**Duplicate Disaster** — search first; parallel records **break reporting** and **commissions**.

Scenarios *(training cues)*

1 — The 130-Day Ghost Town

Situation — **Customer** account; **not** Strategic; **not** E-Rate. **Zero** Salesforce activity **130** days. You want to reach out **today**.

Choice	Coach's line
Rookie move	"Past 121 — I'm dialing **now**." → *Internal friction.* Window may allow outreach, but **reach the listed owner first**.
Strong move	**Coordinate** with the owner; if unresponsive, **ROE transfer steps through leadership** before you "claim" the account.

2 — The "Sent Folder" Defense

Situation — Inbound assigned **Monday**. **Day 6** (next week): **no** Salesforce activity. You: *"But I emailed them twice from Outlook!"*

Choice	Coach's line
Wrong	"Outlook proves I'm working it." → **Dead wrong. Sent** doesn't pay out. **Five business days** for **contact + Salesforce log**.
Right	If it is **not logged in Salesforce**, leadership can treat it as **not done** — log **going forward** and clarify with your manager if the lead moved.

Knowledge-check anchors

- **5 business days** — first contact **+** log for **assigned inbound** only (vs self-sourced).
- **121+** — general **Customer** idle; **61+** — general **Prospect** idle.
- **Strategic list** — **Sales Managers + VP of Sales**; **Sales SharePoint** per ROE.
- **E-Rate / USAC** — **Strategic-style**; **not** casual 61/121.
- **Transfers** — incumbent → manager → leadership **in writing**.

Reference

Title: Sales Rules of Engagement (ROE) — Revised August 2025

SharePoint (PDF):
https://gpcom.sharepoint.com/:b:/r/sites/gpcSales/ROE/Sales%20Rules%20of%20Engagement%20(ROE)%20-%20Revised%20August%2025.pdf?csf=1&web=1&e=7aw2jN

ROE and Strategic list mechanics evolve — this handout is a study aid only. Decisions belong to the current official PDF, SharePoint materials, and sales leadership.